10. See esp. Chapter 1, for a discussion of the Saljuqs' historical adoption of Islam during the tenth century CE and their later confessionalism.
11. In addition to the focus here on the twelfth century, Anooshahr (2018b: 2–3) outlines the process for the fifteenth- and sixteenth-century emergence of the global Islamic empires, but applicable here also: "… Persian historical narratives reified and attempted to construct stable categories such as 'kings' [and] 'dynasties' … out of chaotic military–political events … invent[ing] identities for the individuals involved (no longer as a band of armed men but as 'founders' or 'warrior-kings')."
12. Cf. esp. recent studies by Cribb 2020; Cribb 2020 (forthcoming); also O'Neal 2016; O'Neal 2020. See also Chapter 1.
13. See esp. Ball (2020), who convincingly argued that the various zones encompassed within modern Afghanistan are unique for their array of "vigorous pre-Islamic art and architecture," attributable to the incursions of various Hephthalite groups during the fourth century onward and the subsequent expansion of the Western Turk empire (late sixth century). Cf. also *infra* and Chapter 3.
14. Among the pioneering documentation of Ghur's architectural remains I include the photographs of Josephine Powell, available at: http://hcl.harvard.edu/libraries/finearts/collections/photographers_archives.cfm. While Powell's photographs were complemented by Herberg's documentation and preliminary analyses (1978, 1982), Powell's work continued to be useful for Ball's (2002) study of the region. See also Introduction and *infra* in main text.
15. Thomas 2018: 249 and *passim*.
16. While there is surely more information to be gathered, to date O'Neal's (2017) meticulous mapping of the Mongol campaigns in Afghanistan does much to identify the zones likely experiencing the greatest impact from their incursions. It is probable that there were at least three separate though simultaneous campaigns and nodes where more than one raiding party overlapped, specifically (from east to west) at Parwan, Ghazna, Ahangaran, Jam-Firuzkuh, Marv al-Rudh, and Herat. At least one raid probably reached Tiginabad/Old Qandahar. Curiously, among the three raids converging at Ahangaran, there was only one documentable offshoot southward into the heart of Ghur. This raiding party appears to have reached the Rud-i Ghur's headwaters in the Yakhan Valley, closely following the Ghuris' (including the Shansabanis' ancestors) north–south migration routes. While Juzjani's direct experience of the Mongol campaigns in Afghanistan renders his *Tabaqat* among the most important sources on the period, his patronage by Delhi's Nasir al-Din Mahmud (r. AH 644–664/1246–1266 CE) surely also played a role in the author's interpretations. Jackson (2017: 19) observed that Juzjani's exaggeration of Mongol destruction "enabled [him] to portray the Delhi Sultanate as the sole surviving bastion of Islam," with the book taking on "at times an apocalyptic tone." Nizami (1983: 90–92), however, thought Juzjani's first-hand account of the Mongols was valuable, in particular his balanced portrayal of Chingiz Khan. Cf. also Auer 2012: 19; Auer 2018: 101–102. But rather than a Mongol monopoly on destruction, several centuries later other actors also continued the erasure of Ghur's historical traces: internecine turmoil among